

IT Service Desk Glossary

Alphabetized reference of 45+ IT and service desk terms used at Summit IT Services. Definitions are written for IT staff at all levels, including L1 Service Desk analysts.

A

Active Directory (AD) Microsoft's on-premises directory service for managing users, computers, and policies within a Windows domain. Summit IT uses the cloud version, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure AD), rather than traditional on-premises AD.

Asset Tag A unique identifier assigned to each piece of Summit IT hardware (e.g., SUM-LT-04881 for a laptop). Asset tags are used to track devices in the CMDB and are required when opening hardware-related tickets.

Autopilot (Windows Autopilot) A Microsoft feature that automates the setup and enrollment of Windows devices into Microsoft Intune without requiring manual imaging. When a user signs into a device registered in Autopilot, it automatically downloads policies and applications.

B

BitLocker Microsoft's full-disk encryption feature for Windows. Summit IT enforces BitLocker on all Windows laptops via Intune policy. If a device is lost or stolen, BitLocker prevents unauthorized access to data.

BEC (Business Email Compromise) A type of phishing attack in which an attacker impersonates an executive or trusted contact via email to trick employees into transferring money, sharing sensitive information, or changing financial details. All suspected BEC reports go immediately to SOC and Finance.

BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) A policy permitting employees to use personal devices for work purposes. Summit IT does not currently support a standard BYOD program; all managed endpoints must be company-issued devices enrolled in Intune or Jamf.

C

CAB (Change Advisory Board) A group responsible for reviewing and approving proposed IT changes before they are implemented, to prevent unintended disruptions. Emergency changes during a P1 incident may bypass CAB with IC approval but must be submitted retrospectively.

CMDB (Configuration Management Database) A database that stores information about IT assets and their relationships - hardware, software, users, and configurations. Summit IT's CMDB is maintained within SummitDesk (<https://help.summitit.com>).

Company Portal The Microsoft Intune self-service app installed on Windows endpoints. Users browse and install IT-approved software via Company Portal. IT staff use it to verify app deployment status on managed Windows devices.

CrowdStrike Falcon Summit IT's endpoint detection and response (EDR) platform. CrowdStrike Falcon monitors all managed endpoints for threats, automatically quarantines malicious files, and provides real-time visibility to the SOC. The console is at <https://falcon.crowdstrike.com>.

D

DEP (Device Enrollment Program) Apple's legacy program (now part of Apple Business Manager/ABM) that allows Summit IT to automatically enroll Mac and iOS devices into Jamf Pro when they are activated. See also: ABM.

E

EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response) A security technology that continuously monitors endpoints for suspicious activity, detects threats in real time, and enables security teams to investigate and respond. CrowdStrike Falcon is Summit IT's EDR solution.

Entra ID (Microsoft Entra ID) Microsoft's cloud-based identity and directory service, formerly known as Azure Active Directory (Azure AD). Entra ID manages Summit IT user accounts in the Microsoft 365 ecosystem, synced from Okta via SAML federation.

F

FileVault Apple's built-in full-disk encryption for macOS. Jamf Pro enforces FileVault on all Summit IT MacBook Pros. The encryption recovery key is escrowed in Jamf Pro.

Full-Tunnel VPN A VPN configuration in which all network traffic (both corporate and internet-bound) is routed through the corporate VPN gateway. Summit IT's standard GlobalProtect profile uses full-tunnel. Contrast with Split-Tunnel VPN.

G

GlobalProtect Palo Alto Networks' VPN client used by Summit IT for remote access. GlobalProtect authenticates via Okta SAML + MFA and connects users to the corporate network from outside the office. The portal address is `vpn.summitit.com`.

I

IAM (Identity and Access Management) The discipline of managing digital identities and controlling what resources users can access. At Summit IT, IAM is primarily handled through Okta (SSO, MFA, lifecycle management) and Microsoft Entra ID.

INC (Incident Ticket) A SummitDesk ticket type used to track an unplanned interruption or degradation of an IT service. Incident ticket IDs follow the format **INC-#####**. Contrast with REQ (Service Request).

Incident vs. Request An **incident** is an unplanned disruption to a service (e.g., email not working, laptop crashed). A **request** is a planned ask for something new or a standard change (e.g., new software, VPN access). Incidents use INC tickets; requests use REQ tickets. Distinguishing them correctly affects routing and SLA.

Intune (Microsoft Intune) Microsoft's cloud-based mobile device management (MDM) and mobile application management (MAM) platform. Summit IT uses Intune to manage all Windows endpoints - deploying software, enforcing security policies, and managing device compliance.

IOC (Indicator of Compromise) Evidence that a system or account may have been breached. Common IOCs include unusual login times, unknown IP addresses, malicious file hashes, and suspicious email sender addresses. SOC analysts document IOCs in incident tickets.

ITSM (IT Service Management) A set of policies and practices for designing, delivering, and managing IT services. Summit IT's ITSM platform is SummitDesk (ServiceNow-compatible), used to log, track, and resolve incidents and requests.

J

Jamf Pro Summit IT's MDM platform for managing Apple Mac devices (MacBook Pro). Jamf Pro enforces security policies, deploys software, and manages device inventory. IT staff access it at <https://summit.jamfcloud.com>. Users access IT-approved Mac software via **Self Service**.

K

Knowledge Base (KB) A collection of documented solutions, how-to guides, and reference articles in SummitDesk, accessible to both IT staff and end users at <https://help.summitit.com>. L1 staff should always search the KB before escalating.

L

L1 / L2 / L3 (Support Tiers) Summit IT's tiered support model. **L1** (Service Desk) handles first contact, basic troubleshooting, and triage. **L2** (Desktop & Systems) handles endpoint, account, and application issues requiring more expertise. **L3** (Engineering & Infrastructure) handles network, servers, identity, and cloud infrastructure. Escalation moves tickets from L1 -> L2 -> L3 -> Vendor as needed.

LAPS (Local Administrator Password Solution) A Microsoft feature that automatically manages and rotates the local administrator password on Windows devices. Intune policy enforces LAPS on all Summit IT Windows endpoints to prevent credential reuse attacks.

M

MDM (Mobile Device Management) Technology that allows IT to remotely manage, configure, and secure mobile and desktop devices. Summit IT uses **Intune** for Windows MDM and **Jamf Pro** for Mac MDM. MDM enables policy enforcement, app deployment, and remote wipe.

MFA (Multi-Factor Authentication) A security method requiring users to verify their identity with two or more factors (e.g., password + Okta Verify push). Summit IT enforces MFA for all users via Okta. Privileged accounts additionally use a YubiKey hardware token.

MFP (Multifunction Printer) A combined printer/scanner/copier device. Summit IT deploys HP and Xerox MFPs in offices, managed via **PaperCut** print management software.

O

Okta Summit IT's identity provider (IdP) and SSO platform. Okta is the primary source of truth for user identities, authentication, and application access. All enterprise apps use Okta for sign-in. IT staff manage users at <https://summitit.okta.com/admin>.

Okta Verify Okta's mobile MFA application. Users receive push notifications in Okta Verify to approve login attempts. All Summit IT users must enroll Okta Verify as their primary MFA factor.

Onboarding The process of setting up accounts, devices, and access for a new employee. See RUN-002 (account provisioning) and RUN-010 (hardware imaging). Onboarding begins upon receipt of an HR-submitted new hire request.

Offboarding The process of revoking accounts, devices, and access for a departing employee. See RUN-003. Okta suspension is always the first step to cascade access revocation across all connected systems.

P

P1 / P2 / P3 / P4 (Priority Levels) Summit IT's ticket priority classification. **P1 (Critical):** Major outage, no workaround; 15-min response / 4-hr resolution. **P2 (High):** Significant single-user impact; 1-hr response / 8-hr resolution. **P3 (Medium):** Standard issue with workaround; 4-hr response / 2-day resolution. **P4 (Low):** Request or minor issue; 1-day response / 5-day resolution.

PaperCut The print management platform used by Summit IT to manage print quotas, track usage, and control access to MFPs across all offices.

Phishing A cyberattack in which a threat actor sends a fraudulent email designed to trick the recipient into revealing credentials, clicking a malicious link, or opening a malware-laden attachment. Users can report phishing using the **Report Phishing** button in Outlook or by emailing soc@summitit.com.

PIR (Post-Incident Review) A structured review conducted after a P1 incident to identify root cause, contributing factors, what went well, what failed, and actionable improvements. PIRs are scheduled within 2 business days and published within 5 business days of resolution.

Provisioning The process of creating and configuring a user account, granting access to systems and applications, and deploying hardware. Automated provisioning at Summit IT is handled via Okta's lifecycle management (Okta -> Microsoft 365, Slack, Zoom, etc.).

R

REQ (Service Request Ticket) A SummitDesk ticket type used to track a planned request for a new service, access, or standard change (e.g., new software, shared mailbox, VPN access). REQ ticket IDs follow the format REQ-#####. Contrast with INC (Incident).

RMA (Return Merchandise Authorization) The process of returning defective hardware to a vendor for repair or replacement under warranty. For Dell hardware, RMAs are initiated via the Dell ProSupport portal using the device's Service Tag. See vendor-support-contacts.md.

Runbook A documented, step-by-step procedure for completing a specific IT task or responding to a specific incident type. Summit IT runbooks are stored in the /runbooks/ directory of the knowledge base and follow the RUN-### naming scheme.

S

SAML (Security Assertion Markup Language) An open standard for exchanging authentication and authorization data between an identity provider (Okta) and a service provider (e.g., Microsoft 365, Slack). SAML enables SSO - users authenticate once with Okta and access all connected apps without re-entering credentials.

Self Service (Jamf) The Jamf Pro end-user app installed on Summit IT Mac devices. It is the Mac equivalent of Company Portal - users browse and install IT-approved software for Mac. Available under Applications > Self Service.

SLA (Service Level Agreement) A documented commitment defining the target response and resolution times for IT support requests by priority. Summit IT SLAs: P1 = 15-min response / 4-hr resolution; P2 = 1-hr / 8-hr; P3 = 4-hr / 2-day; P4 = 1-day / 5-day.

SOC (Security Operations Center) Summit IT's security team responsible for monitoring, detecting, and responding to security threats. The SOC monitors CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender, and incoming phishing reports. Contact: soc@summitit.com (24/7).

Split-Tunnel VPN A VPN configuration in which only traffic destined for corporate networks is routed through the VPN, while general internet traffic goes directly. Summit IT offers a split-tunnel profile for specific use cases. Contrast with Full-Tunnel VPN.

SSO (Single Sign-On) An authentication method that allows users to log in once (via Okta at Summit IT) and access multiple applications without entering credentials again for each one. Powered by SAML or OIDC protocols.

SummitDesk Summit IT's ITSM ticketing platform, accessible at <https://help.summitit.com>. Used for logging incidents (INC), service requests (REQ), the knowledge base, and the CMDB. All IT interactions must be logged in SummitDesk.

T

TAM (Technical Account Manager) A dedicated vendor representative who serves as the primary escalation and relationship point for Summit IT's enterprise support contracts. TAM contact details are listed in vendor-support-contacts.md.

Ticket A record in SummitDesk documenting a user's request or reported issue. Every IT action must be associated with a ticket. Tickets contain the issue description, priority, actions taken, communications, and resolution details.

U

UPN (User Principal Name) The login identifier for a user in Microsoft 365 and Okta, following the format `firstname.lastname@summitit.com`. The UPN is the primary identifier used across all Summit IT systems.

V

VPN (Virtual Private Network) An encrypted tunnel over the internet that connects a remote user's device to Summit IT's corporate network. VPN is required for accessing internal resources from outside the office. Summit IT uses Palo Alto GlobalProtect.

W

Workaround A temporary solution that allows a user to continue working while the underlying issue is being investigated. The existence or absence of a workaround is a key factor in setting ticket priority (P2 implies the user can partially work; P1 implies no workaround at all).

Y

YubiKey A hardware security key (USB/NFC token) manufactured by Yubico. Summit IT requires YubiKey as a second MFA factor for all privileged and admin accounts, providing phishing-resistant authentication beyond Okta Verify push.

This glossary is maintained by the Summit IT Service Desk team. To suggest additions or corrections, submit a REQ ticket at <https://help.summitit.com> with the category "Knowledge Base / Glossary."
